Skills Summary

Making Ten

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Ten is made of two parts. A full ten-frame holds 10. The dots you see and the empty squares are the two parts.

The partners of ten: 0 and 10   1 and 9   2 and 8   3 and 7   4 and 6   5 and 5.

Learn these six pairs and every question on the worksheet becomes a lookup, not a count.

1. Finding the missing part of ten

Fill the frame in your head. Count the *empty* squares — do not start back at one. A full top row is 5, so anything past 5 has only the bottom row left to fill.

Example: $7 + \underline{\qquad} = 10$

Step 1. The whole is ten and one part is given, so the question is asking for the partner of seven — fill the frame, do not recount it.

Step 2. Seven dots fill the top row and two of the bottom row, so three squares are still empty.

$\Rightarrow$ **3**, because $7 + 3 = 10$.

Try it: $4 + \underline{\qquad} = 10$

check: **6**

2. Taking a part away from ten

This is the same picture read backwards. If you take one part away from ten, what is left is the *other* part. So if you know the partners of ten, you already know every subtraction from ten — no counting back needed.

Example: $10 - 6 = \underline{\qquad}$

Step 1. Ten is the whole and six is one part, so the answer is six's partner — the same pair as before, used the other way round.

Step 2. Six dots leave four empty squares on the frame.

$\Rightarrow$ **4**, because $6 + 4 = 10$.

Try it: $10 - 2 = \underline{\qquad}$

check: **8**

3. Using ten to add a bigger number

Adding to ten is easy, so *make* a ten first. Fill the frame from the second number, then count on with whatever is left over. Break the second number into two pieces: the piece that finishes the ten, and the rest.

Example: $9 + 5$
Step 1. Nine is nearly ten, so filling the frame first turns a hard fact into an easy one.
Step 2. Nine needs one more, so break the five into 1 and 4: $9 + 1 = 10$, then $10 + 4$.
$\Rightarrow$ **14**

Try it: $8 + 5$ (how many does 8 need to make ten?)

check: **13**

(!) Watch out: when you make a ten, do not forget the leftovers. If you move counters into the frame, check your hand — is it empty? Stopping at 10 is the most common mistake on the last few problems.